

c.1945

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by  
the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

(typed on a Christmas card:)

ALWAYS CHRISTMAS EVE.  
Nay - INFINITELY MORE, FOR DAILY COMMUNICANTS

With love and with Christmas greetings to all  
Comes the Infant once more to free us from sorrow  
Whose smile and Whose power and Whose gentleness call  
To each heart and each soul for a Manger Tomorrow;

Whose love and whose goodness--Whose wonders proclaim  
Him, the Son of the Virgin, as Promised of yore.-  
O! may He estrange us from sin and its shame!-  
And reign in our Heart, as His crib evermore!

/s/ Fr. Solanus, O.F.M. Cap.

(added in Fr. Solanus' hand:)

"Christ wrought Redemption from despair and sin  
By His dear Cross the clouds of grief were riven  
'Tis Bethlem and Calvary that win, from  
Pain and Sorrow the sweets of Heaven.

(above four lines quoted from:) Rev. Fr. Edward Casey

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(printed verse on card:)

AND SHE BROUGHT FORTH HER FIRSTBORN  
SON, AND WRAPPED HIM IN SWADDLING  
CLOTHES, AND LAID HIM IN A MANGER... (Luke 2, 7)

added verse by Fr. Solanus)  
Ah! The rest of us, on Calvary--  
Mary conceived under the Cross--  
thirty-three years later.. Glory to God!  
Peace to men of GOOD WILL.

/s/ Fr. Solanus